Sahaj Bhadja

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Summary

Software engineer with experience in **distributed systems**, **Go**, and real-time data pipelines. Proficient in **Kafka**, **PostgreSQL**, Redis, and **Kubernetes**. Comfortable jumping around the stack, wearing multiple hats, and building scalable infrastructure on AWS/GCP.

Education

University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA **August 2024 – May 2026**
Master of Science in Computer Science *GPA: 3.75/4.0*
Coursework: Distributed Systems, Database Systems, Analysis of Algorithms, Computer Networks

Pandit Deendayal Energy University, Gandhinagar, India **November 2020 – May 2024**
Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering *GPA: 3.88/4.0*
Coursework: Data Structures, Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Database Management

Experience

USC Dornsife **Los Angeles, CA**
Software Engineer *September 2025 – Present*

- Built **distributed systems** components using **Go** and **Kafka** for real-time data processing, making tradeoffs between memory and disk to optimize pipeline efficiency.
- Deployed services on **Kubernetes** with **Terraform** on GCP, directly interacting with stakeholders to shape product direction while wearing multiple hats across the stack.

Grad8 **Los Angeles, CA**
Software Engineer Intern *June 2025 – August 2025*

- Developed **async systems** using **Go** and **Kafka** for message processing, building tooling to streamline and automate infrastructure workloads on **AWS**.
- Built frontend features using **TypeScript (React)** while comfortable jumping around the stack, deploying with **Kubernetes** and **Helm** for container orchestration.

USC AD Labs **Los Angeles, CA**
ML Research Assistant *January 2025 – May 2025*

- Scaled **distributed data pipelines** using **Go** and **Redis** for caching, improving system throughput by 18% through pragmatic engineering decisions.
- Worked with **PostgreSQL** and **Elasticsearch** for data storage and search, taking an active role in defining system architecture and data flow.

Aasma Technology Solutions **India**
Software Developer Engineer - (SecureSync) *August 2023 – July 2024*

- Built real-time data synchronization services using **Go**, **Kafka**, and **gRPC**, implementing **change data capture (CDC)** patterns for low-latency replication.
- Deployed on **Kubernetes** with **Terraform** on AWS, caring more about building the right thing vs. being right while directly interacting with customers.

StreamTech Systems **India**
Backend Engineer Intern *January 2023 – April 2023*

- Developed **Go microservices** for real-time **stream processing** with **Kafka**, building native connectors to various data sources for CDC pipelines.
- Worked with **PostgreSQL**, **Redis**, and **Elasticsearch**, gaining strong fundamentals in **distributed systems** and infrastructure automation.

Skills

Languages: Go, TypeScript, Python, SQL
Distributed Systems: Kafka, gRPC, Redis, Elasticsearch, stream processing, CDC
Databases: PostgreSQL, Redis, Elasticsearch
Infrastructure: Kubernetes, Helm, Terraform, Docker, AWS, GCP

Projects

StreamSync | *Go, Kafka, PostgreSQL, Redis, Kubernetes*

- Built real-time **data streaming pipeline in Go** with Kafka for CDC, replicating data across systems with zero maintenance and sub-second latency.

DataPipe | *Go, gRPC, Terraform, AWS*

- Developed **native CDC connectors** in Go with gRPC, building tooling to automate infrastructure workloads and streamline data replication workflows.

FinNexus Live | *TypeScript (React), Go, PostgreSQL*

- Built full-stack platform with **React frontend and Go backend**, comfortable jumping around the stack to deliver mission-critical financial analytics.